

A Simple Agreement and Scope

A friendly one-page note for when a client says yes

Prepared for Mark Strazisar

This is a plain language note you can use to set up any arrangement, Mark. It is not a scary legal contract. It is a friendly, clear page that says what you will do, what it costs, and who owns what. Having it protects you, keeps the work from creeping bigger than you agreed, and makes you look professional.

Use it for a retainer, a project, or even a single document. Fill in the blanks, send it as an email or a one page attachment, and ask them to reply yes. For anything large or unusual, it is worth having a lawyer look it over. For a normal documents arrangement, a clear note like this is usually plenty.

Why this matters for you specifically. The biggest risk to your health and your peace of mind is scope creep, which is when a job quietly grows past what you agreed to. A clear scope stops that before it starts. When everyone knows that a month includes a set amount of work, a busy or hard week never turns into guilt or pressure. This page is your protection.

What to spell out, every time

1. What you will deliver.

Be specific and countable. Not "improve our training," but "three finished documents per month, chosen together from an agreed list." Countable work protects you. It means a month is done when the agreed documents are done, no matter how many hours it took.

2. How you charge and when you are paid.

- Retainer: a flat monthly fee, paid at the start of each month.
- Project: a fixed price, paid in thirds. One third to start, one third at the halfway point, one third on delivery.
- Per document: a set price per document, paid when each one is delivered.

3. How revisions work.

Say how many rounds of changes are included, so it does not go on forever. A fair standard is up to two rounds of revisions per document. Beyond that, it is a new small charge. Most documents never need more than two rounds.

4. Who owns what.

- The finished documents you build for the client, with their name, menu, and private details in them, belong to the client.
- Your own templates, your methods, and your general know how stay yours. You may reuse a clean version with their private details removed for other clients.
- You keep their private information private. You do not share their recipes, numbers, or internal details with anyone.

5. The pace, around your life.

Make it clear that the work is measured by the finished documents over the month, not by hours or by a daily schedule. You deliver the agreed work within the month, working when you are able. This is the line that protects your hard days.

6. Ending it.

Either side can end the arrangement with a short, friendly notice, such as two weeks. Any work already finished is paid for. Simple and fair.

A ready to use template

Copy this, fill in the blanks, and send it. Keep it warm and short.

SIMPLE WORKING AGREEMENT

Between: [Your name], operations documentation

And: [Client name]

Date: [Date]

THE WORK

I will create operational and training documents for [client name].

This month we have agreed on these: [list the documents, or "an agreed set of [number] finished documents per month, chosen together"].

This work is floor level operations and training. It does not include human resources, hiring, payroll, or legal compliance.

THE FEE

[] Monthly retainer: \$[amount] per month, paid at the start of each month.

[] Project: \$[amount] total, paid in thirds (start, halfway, delivery).

[] Per document: \$[amount] per document, paid on delivery.

REVISIONS

Up to two rounds of changes are included per document.

PACE

The work is measured by the finished documents agreed for the month, not by hours. I deliver the agreed work within the month, working at my own pace.

WHO OWNS WHAT

Finished documents made for [client name], with their details in them, belong to [client name]. My own general templates and methods, with your private details removed, remain mine to reuse. I keep your private information confidential.

ENDING

Either of us can end this with two weeks notice. Finished work is paid for.

Agreed by: _____ Date: _____
[Client name]

Agreed by: _____ Date: _____
[Your name]

A short note for the salary situation. If you are still on the payroll when you set this up, this same page does double duty. It draws a clear line between your regular job and this paid arrangement, and it puts the ownership of your reusable templates in writing. Get a yes on this before you deliver any paid work. It keeps everything friendly and clean.

Keep it simple, keep it clear, and keep a copy of every agreement in your Clients folder.